



AI Implementation and Adoption Best Practices

Introduction

These best practice examples showcase how leading organizations are successfully implementing AI and driving employee AI adoption.

HR leaders can use this presentation to:

- 1 Get inspired by best practices from HR and enterprise leaders
- 2 Gain visibility into how to achieve AI deployment goals
- 3 Understand best practices for AI deployment

Methodology:

Best practice examples were sourced from extensive interviews with HR and enterprise leaders. Examples were also obtained from existing case studies on Gartner.com, which have been cited in this presentation.*

* Some content may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

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U.S. Venture (Redesign Work Processes to Unlock GenAI Transformation)

Source: [Case Study: Redesign Work Processes to Unlock GenAI Transformation](#)

Redesign Work Processes to Unlock GenAI Transformation

Overview

U.S. Venture redesigns processes across the enterprise alongside GenAI integration to align workflows with its ambitious technology-enabled growth goals. HR breaks down silos in the organization to identify opportunities for automation and augmentation with GenAI and guide changes to legacy processes. As a result, GenAI integration unlocks employees' potential to do meaningful work and drive organizational growth.

Scenario

Over the past several years, U.S. Venture has experienced rapid growth, expanding its market coverage and more than doubling its workforce.

U.S. Venture recognized that GenAI integration and automation were central to driving continuous growth and organizational innovation, but existing work processes restricted the impact of new technology, exacerbating work friction.

About U.S. Venture

Industry: Energy, utilities and transportation
Headquarters: Appleton, WI, U.S.

Revenue: 13 Billion USD (2025)
Employees: 5,000 (2025)

Solution highlights

- **System to surface and design automation opportunities:** Gather employee data on work friction to design new automated processes that address work challenges and lay the foundation for greater GenAI use.
- **Collaborative work process mapping exercise:** Observe employee workflows and create journey maps to adapt the work process in complement to GenAI tools and encourage focus on value-add work.
- **HR-led task valuations to evolve role design:** Assess tasks for GenAI replacement and automation and change role expectations to focus employees on growth-driving work that technology can't perform.



Nicole Carter
VP of
Talent Management

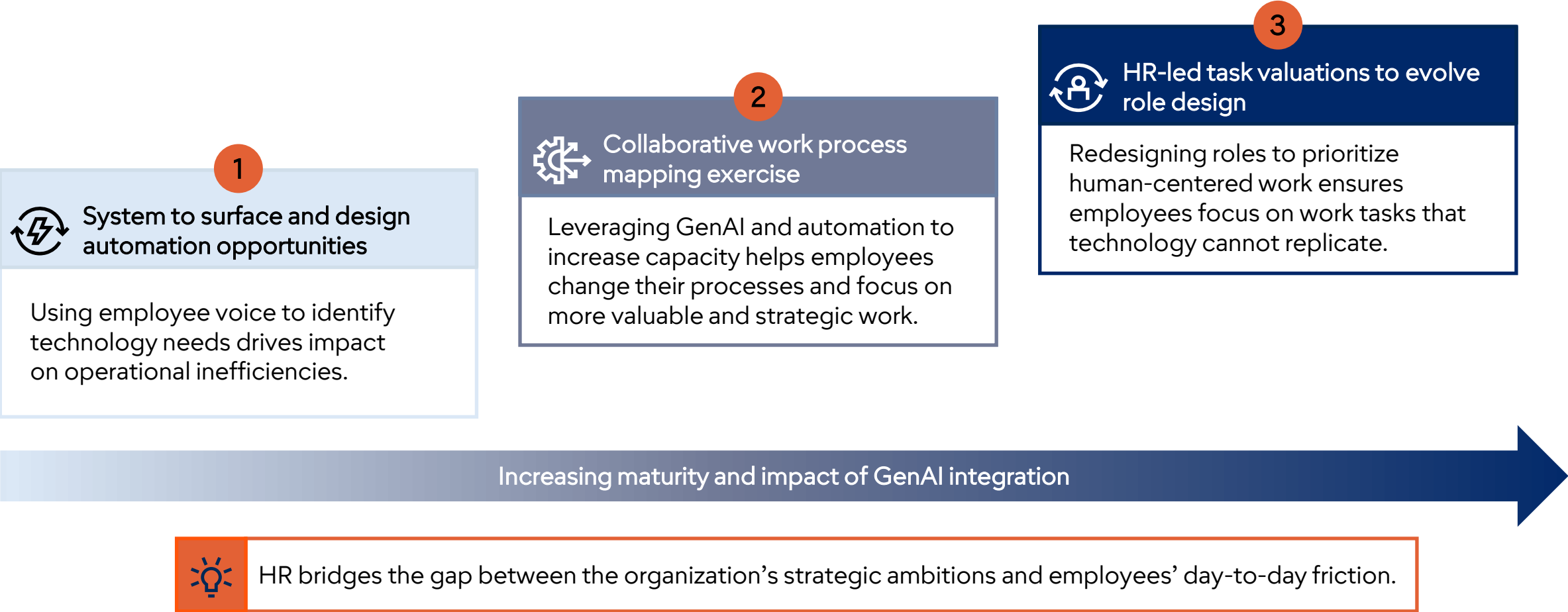


Lori Hoersch
Chief People Officer



HR Must Coordinate Change, Not Layer Technology

How U.S. Venture’s HR Leaders Achieve GenAI-Driven Growth
Illustrative



Source: Adapted from U.S. Venture

The Fundamental Catalyst for Work Transformation

How HR Operationalizes U.S. Venture’s “Find a Better Way” Growth Strategy



“Find a better way” (FABW) primes employees to accept and help the organization design new and different in-kind work as organizational changes (i.e., GenAI integration) dictate.

Context:

Since 2019, U.S. Venture has more than doubled in size. With workforce growth came the fear of stagnation from senior leadership.

HR sought to further embed a culture of innovation into the fabric of U.S. Venture, revitalizing its “find a better way” strategy.

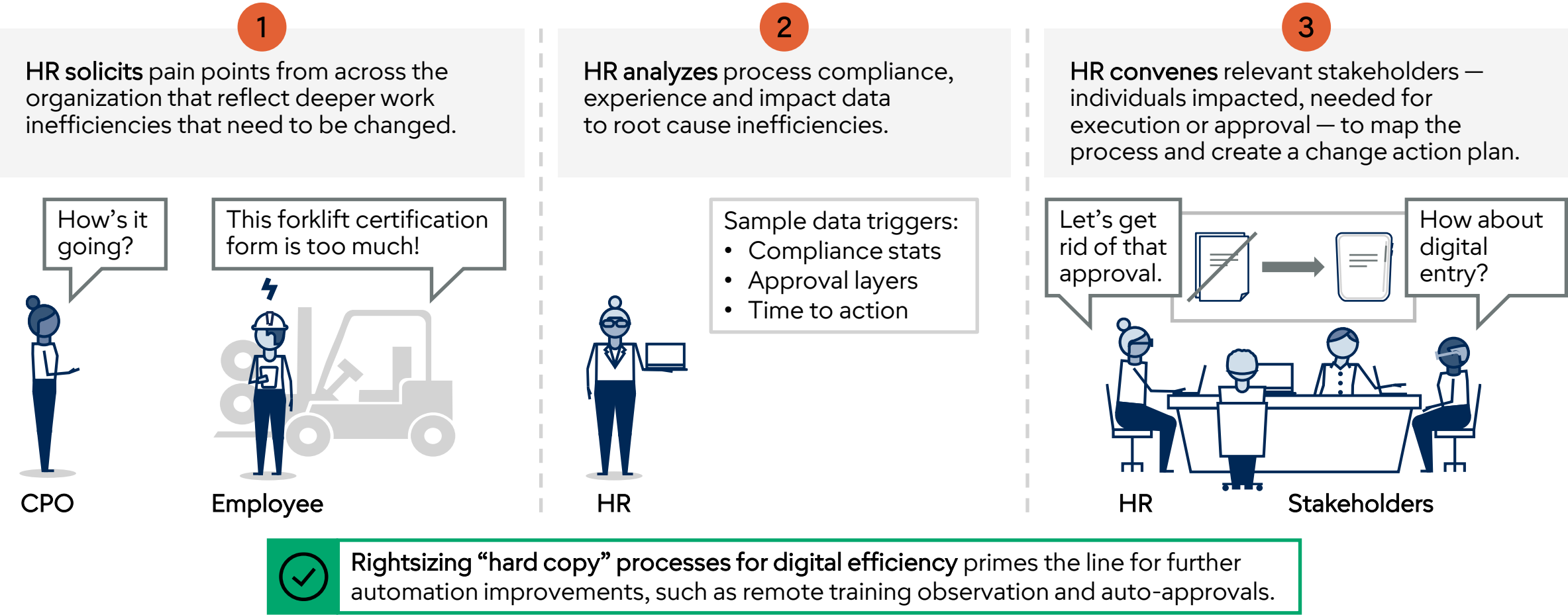
Source: Adapted from U.S. Venture

Note: For more information on U.S. Venture’s Find a Better Way cultural pillars, visit their website at <https://www.usventure.com/about-us/company-culture/>

Optimize Operating Procedures for Tech Advancement

System to Surface and Design Automation Opportunities

Illustrative: A case in point from U.S. Venture’s AutoForce business

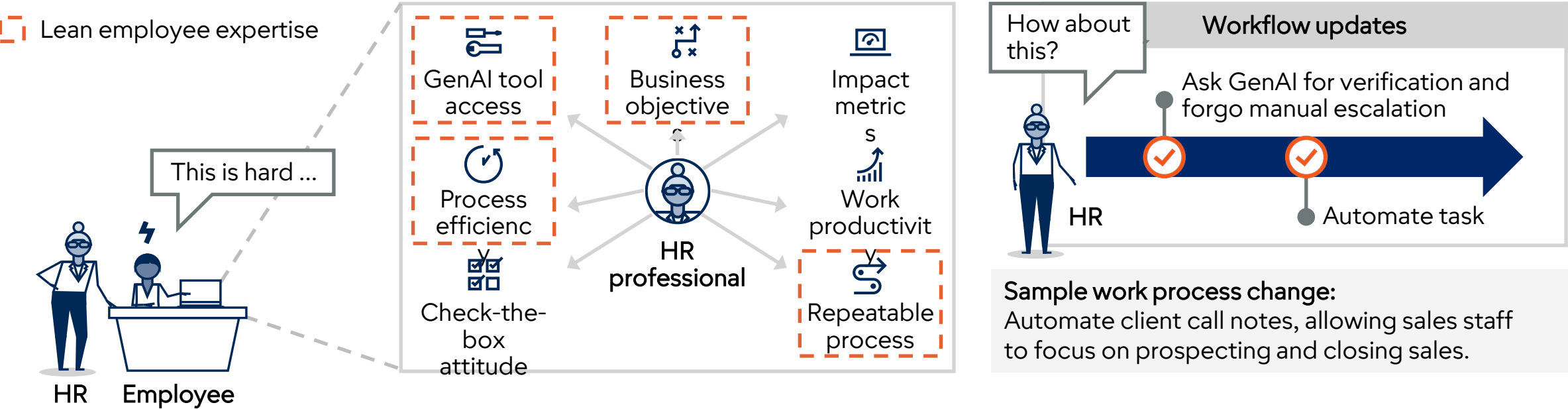


Source: Adapted from U.S. Venture

Redirect Work Processes Toward Revenue-Driving Tasks

Collaborative Work Process-Mapping Exercise

Illustrative: A case in point from U.S. Venture's sales function

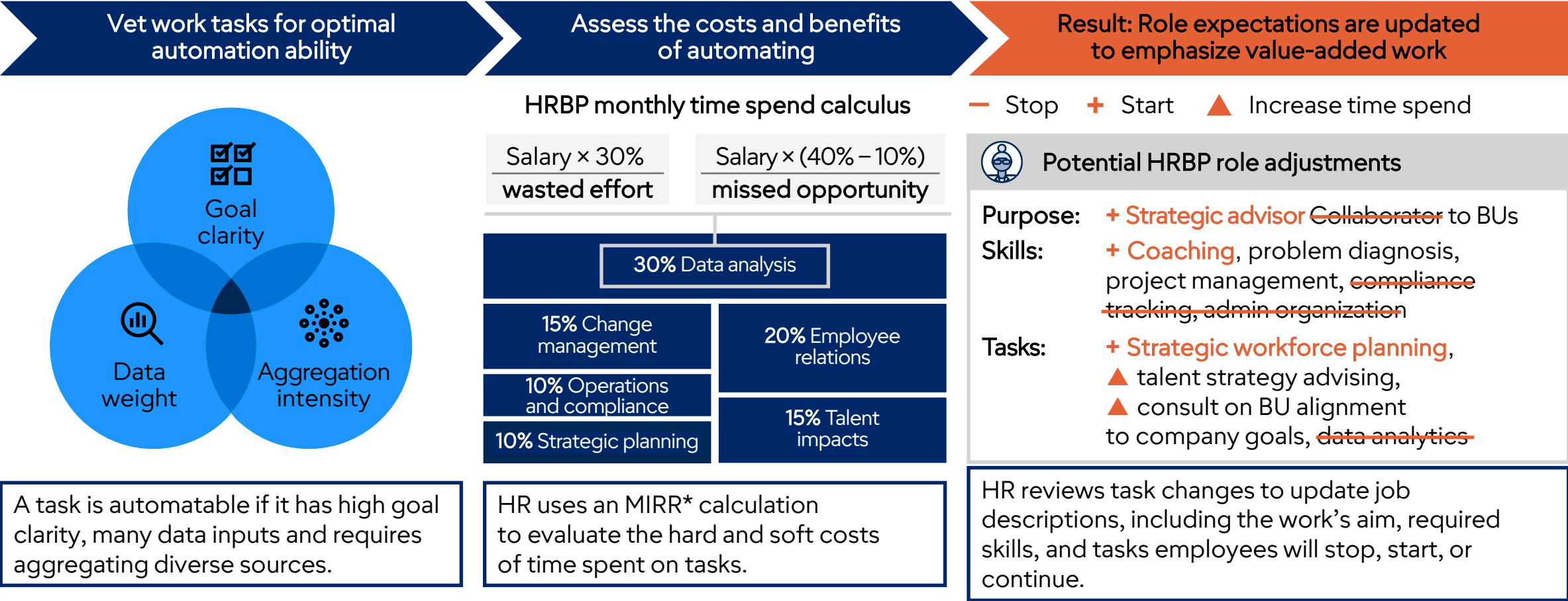


Coming soon: HR is certifying employee volunteers who are champions in Lean methodology. With their business expertise, these individuals will leverage GenAI tools and process improvement methodology to drive continuous improvement throughout the organization.

Source: Adapted from U.S. Venture

Change Employees' Roles to Maximize GenAI Potential

HR-Led Task Valuations to Evolve Role Design
Illustrative: A case in point from U.S. Venture's HR function



Process Changes Aligned With GenAI-Driven Growth

U.S. Venture’s Results

Increased impact of work



U.S. AutoForce’s newly automated forklift certification process has saved employees roughly 82 hours monthly.



The HRBP unit has eliminated 31.25 hours per week of non-value-added work, or approximately 2.5 hours per HRBP.



With new working methods and solutions to process inefficiencies, U.S. Venture anticipates saving approximately \$1.7 million in hard and soft costs over the next three years.

Source: Adapted from U.S. Venture

Stakeholder feedback

“Our sales teams have become more data-driven in their approach, leveraging GenAI tools to prioritize opportunities more effectively and personalize outreach. Over time, this has led to improved conversion rates and shorter sales cycles.

GenAI doesn’t replace salespeople, it empowers them. By automating the data insights and allowing for more professional communications, it lets reps focus on what they do best: building relationships and closing deals.”

Director of sales, U.S. AutoForce

Source: U.S. Venture

McDermott Will & Schulte (Enable Effective AI Use Through Work-Based Learning)

Source: [Case Study: Enable Effective AI Use Through Work-Based Learning](#)

Enable Effective AI Use Through Work-Based Learning

Overview

McDermott Will & Schulte helps employees hone AI skills, by asking employees to bring their own work-based problems to a hands-on learning event. Time is dedicated to practicing solving the identified problems with AI. Employees are placed in peer groups with varying maturity to collaborate and help establish peer networks that can provide support following the event.

Scenario

With AI’s rapid evolution, McDermott Will & Schulte wanted to get ahead of the steep AI learning curve the company knew was ahead of its employees or else risk falling behind as an organization and dealing with the impacts of rogue AI use.

HR realized that by combining IT’s technical capability with its learning expertise, it could focus on building an experiential opportunity for employees to learn at scale. By focusing on AI in the context of how employees do their jobs, they are enabled to independently identify when AI is needed and apply it effectively.

Solution Highlights

- **Employee-defined AI-ready challenges:** Engage employees in a reflection exercise to identify work challenges suitable for AI solutions.
- **Maturity-informed peer skills sharing:** Distribute AI maturity levels among learning teams to create productive skills-sharing and sustained networks for ongoing AI integration support.
- **Design principles for AI practice:** Empower employees to think critically and overcome initial failure, rapidly iterating on AI solutions collaboratively with peers and supported by IT professionals.
- **AI solution showcase:** Jumpstart employee accountability for integrating AI with work by facilitating solution share-outs.

About McDermott Will & Schulte

Industry: Legal services
Headquarters: Chicago, IL, U.S.

Revenue: \$2.2 billion (2024)
Employees: 3,000 (2025)



Embed Work-Based Experimentation Into AI Learning

McDermott Will & Schulte’s Approach to Influence Employees’ AI Use

Typical approach



HR realizes that AI skills evolve too quickly for long periods of unsupported experimentation to translate to impact at work.

⚠️ “How am I even supposed to use AI at work?”

McDermott’s approach



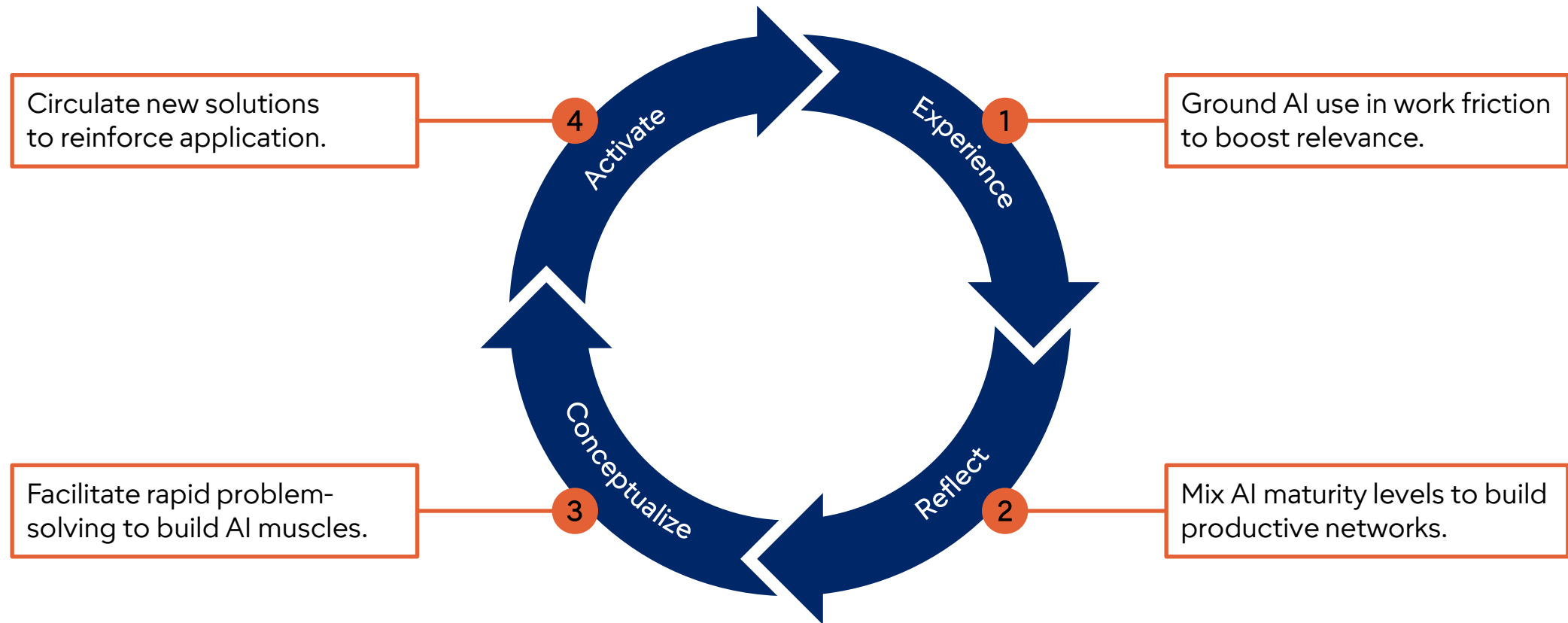
HR partners with IT to embed peer-to-peer AI practice with learning, providing time for supported experimentation and building relevant networks to enable continuous use of AI tools for work tasks.

✅ “I can’t wait to use AI to help me out at work!”

Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte

Translate Knowledge to Action With Experimentation

Interpretation of Kolb's Theory of Experiential Learning Using McDermott's Approach



Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte; Inspired by Kolb, D. A. (1984). *Experiential Learning: Experience as the Source of Learning and Development*. Englewood Cliffs, NJ: Prentice-Hall.

Ground AI Use In Work Friction to Boost Relevance

Employee-Defined AI-Ready Challenges

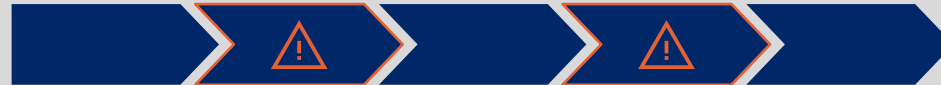
Illustrative

Employees reflect on work experiences to identify problems where AI could help

Questions to help employees identify AI use cases:

- What bottlenecks prevent you from performing at your best?
- What tension points in your workflow cause you to use your time in an inefficient way?
- Are there any check-the-box tasks that overcomplicate your job?
- What small frustrations amplify your daily mental clutter?

Employee workflow issues identified:



Lacking deep AI expertise, employees are encouraged to think about small hurdles where they could be “working smarter.”

Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte

Mix AI Maturity Levels to Build Productive Networks

Maturity-Informed Peer Skills Sharing Illustrative

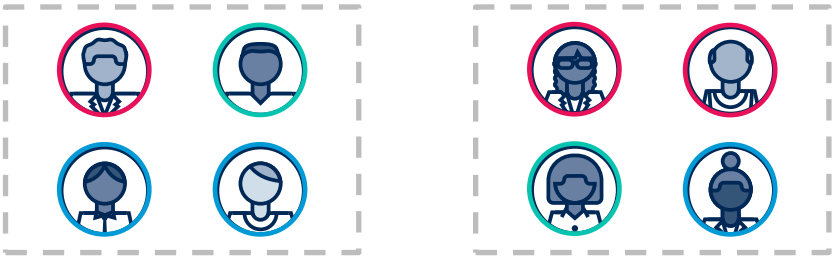
1 Employees identify their AI maturity

○ AI novices ○ AI intermediates ○ AI maestros



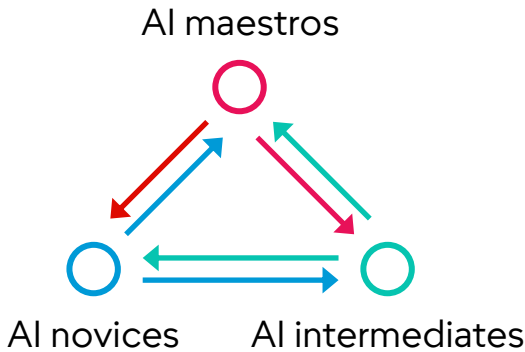
Employees share what AI tools they've used so HR can verify maturity designations.

2 HR creates groups with varied maturity levels



3 Peer-to-peer learning supports AI skill building

More advanced AI users are challenged to teach peers, turning unconscious habits into conscious skills.



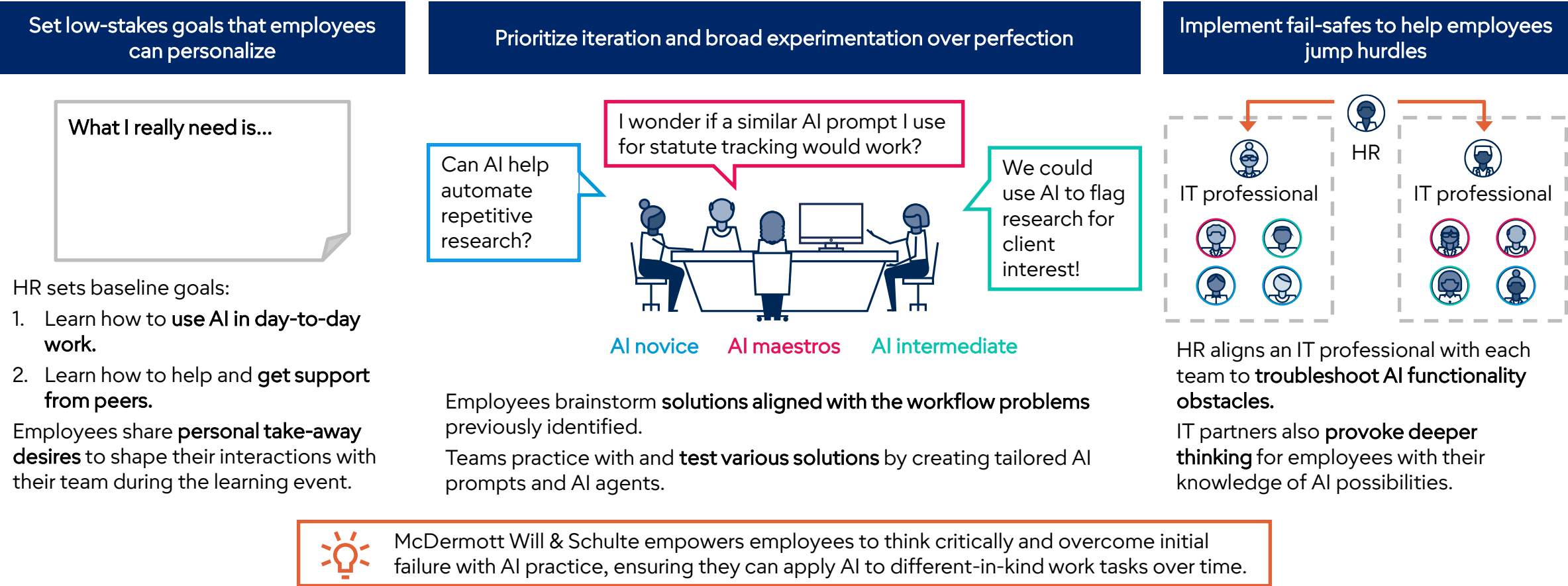
New AI users bring more creativity to solutions practice and help their peers be unrestrained by past experiences in their experimentation.

Less advanced AI users see firsthand the benefits of using AI and build a relevant peer network to go to when they encounter obstacles using AI at work.

Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte

Facilitate Rapid Problem Solving to Build AI Muscles

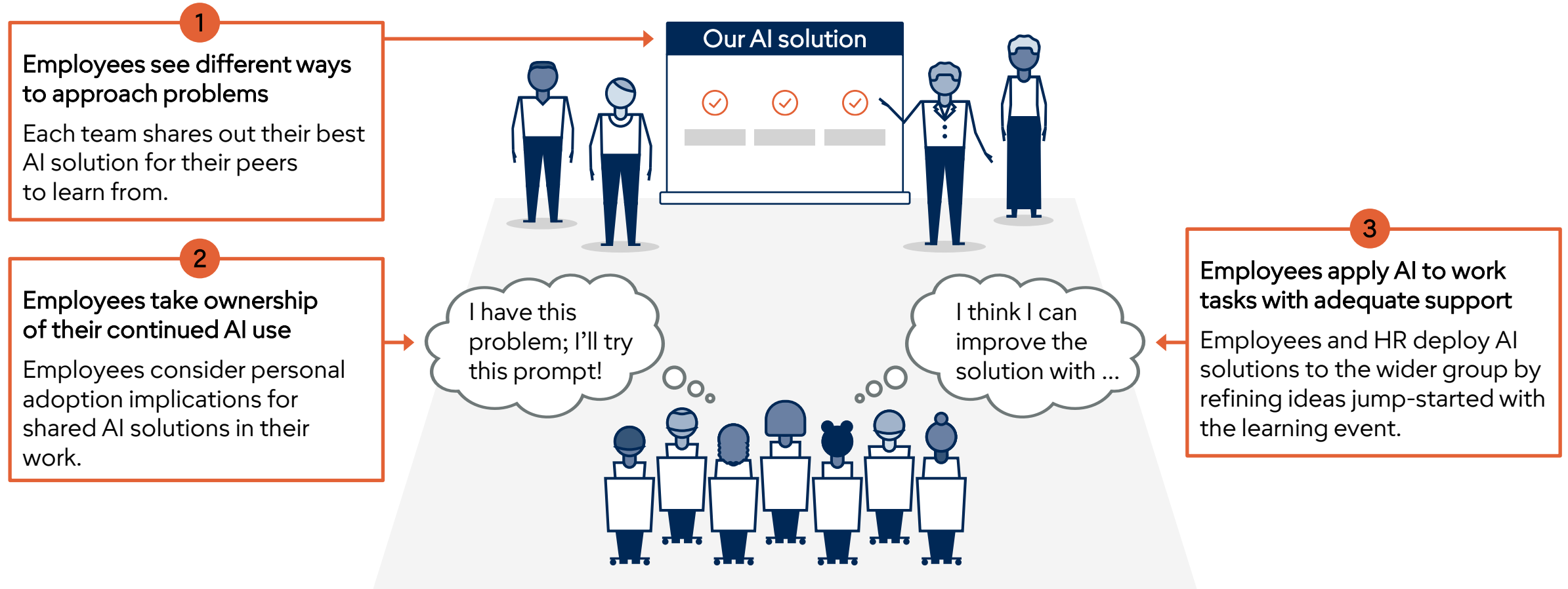
Design Principles for AI Practice Illustrative



Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte

Circulate New Solutions to Reinforce Application

AI Solution Showcase Illustrative



Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte

Work-Based Experimentation Drives Effective AI Use

McDermott Will & Schulte's Results

Greater effective use of AI

McDermott Will & Schulte's CHRO estimates the following impacts following learning events:



85% of employees have increased their AI maturity.



80% of employees have a greater understanding of how to apply AI to their workflows.



80% of employees feel better supported by their peers in using AI on the job.

Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte

Stakeholder feedback

“These learning events foster a sense of permission to use AI on the job, which goes a long way with the novice population.”

CHRO, McDermott Will & Schulte

“We’ve never seen so many light bulbs ignite at once. Employees immediately saw how they could start using AI to help with critical problems at work, thanks to seeing how their peers are using AI.”

IT Leader, McDermott Will & Schulte

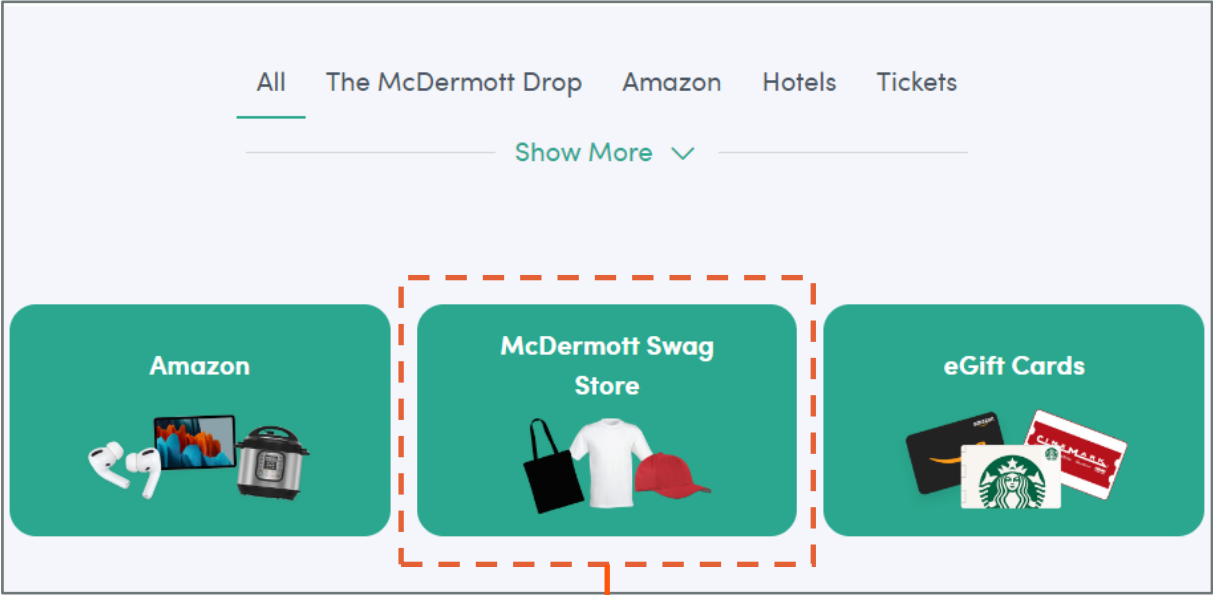
“My direct reports clearly left this event feeling like AI use was a built-in must-have function of their daily work, not just a bolt-on tool to be discarded.”

Manager, McDermott Will & Schulte

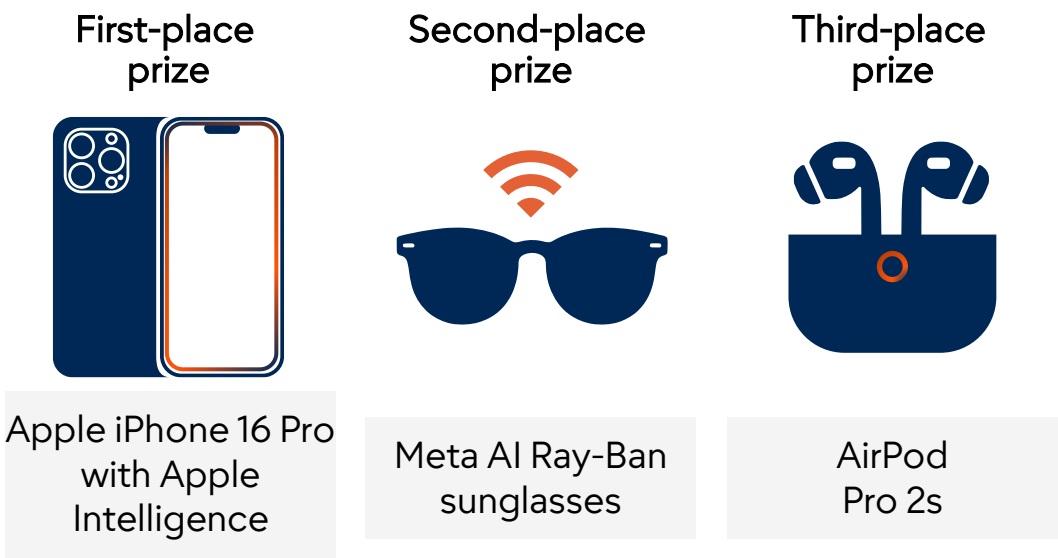
Source: Adapted from McDermott Will & Schulte

Incentivize Ongoing Experimentation With AI

Allotted Prizes for Learning Event Participants
Illustrative




100 points
All participants in the learning event receive 100 reward points from the McDermott swag store.




All participants vote on the best AI solution shared by their peer teams. Members of the teams with the top three AI solutions receive a tech-enabled product.



Lenovo (AI Adoption and Change Management Support for People Managers)



Source: [Case Study: AI Adoption and Change Management Support for People Managers](#)

AI Change Management and Adoption Support for Managers

Overview

Lenovo recognizes the critical role that managers play in leading AI change and equips them with the support necessary to communicate value, manage employee resistance and be force multipliers of AI.

Scenario

Even as enterprises recognize that middle managers are critical to driving and sustaining AI-related change, providing managers with adequate support is often an afterthought. Without enough support, managers struggle to guide their teams through AI's complexity, leading to stalled AI implementations, poor adoption and disengaged teams.

Solution Highlights

- **Uncover managers' AI transformation pain points:** Identify unique motivations, frustrations and challenges of middle managers enterprisewide.
- **Instill an enterprise AI value mindset in managers:** Coach managers on articulating AI value stories to effectively communicate value upwards.
- **Equip managers to address employee change barriers:** Prepare managers to tackle employees' emotional resistance to AI-related change.
- **Partner with managers to facilitate AI change:** Identify opportunities to alleviate managers' change leadership burden by tailoring support to their teams.



Linda Yao

VP, Hybrid Cloud & AI
Solutions



Sarah Lundgren

Director,
Transformation Office



Cristina Ursu

AI Transformation &
Client Adoption Lead

About Lenovo

Industry: Technology

Headquarters: Morrisville, NC, U.S.

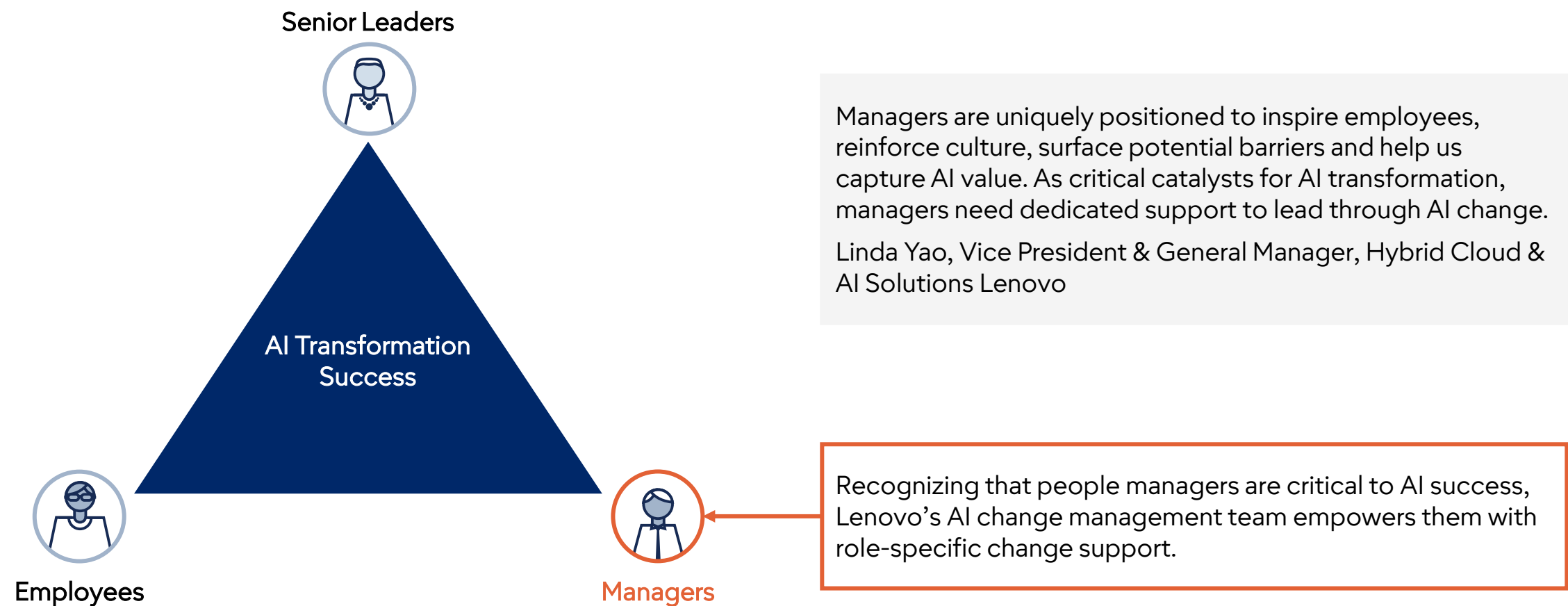
Revenue: ~ 69.1 Billion USD (2024)

Employees: ~70,000 (2024)

Lenovo

Formalized AI Change Support for Managers

People Managers as a Key Workforce Segment for AI Transformation

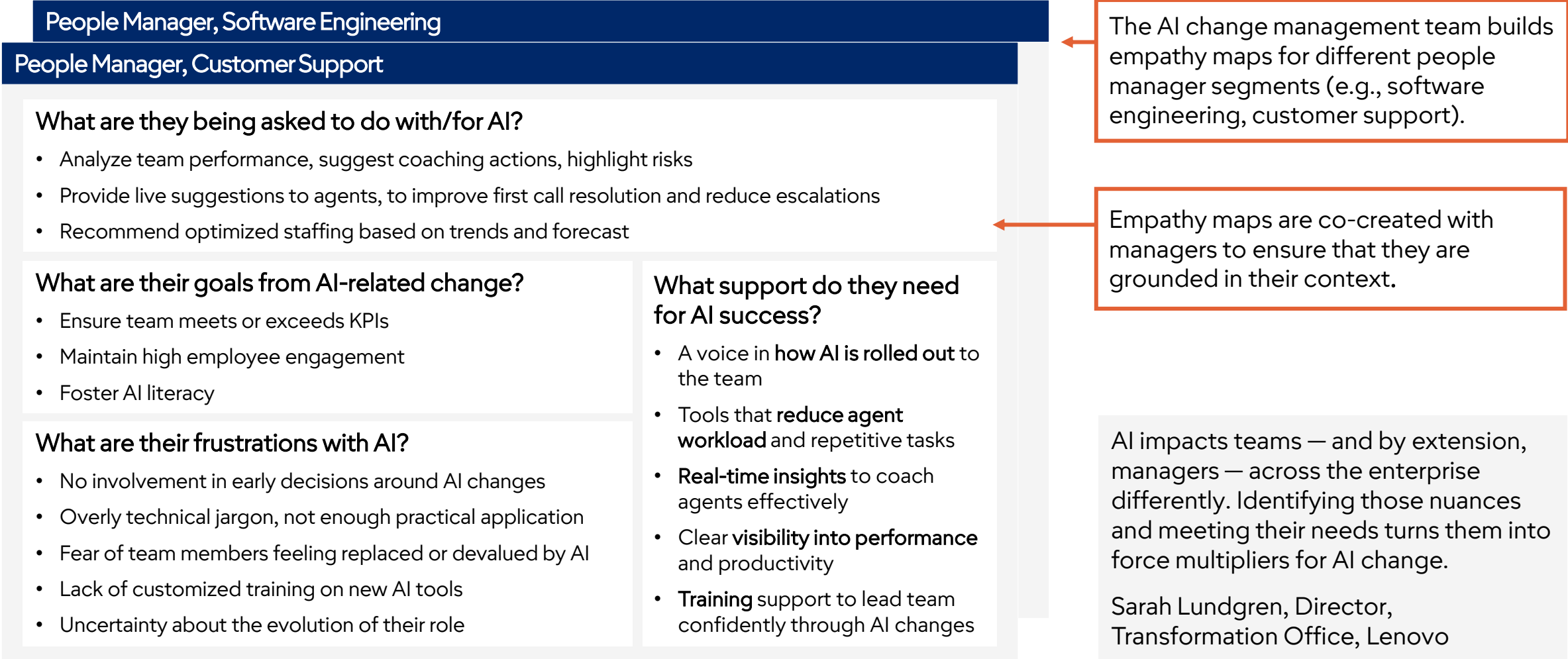


Source: Adapted from Lenovo



Uncover Managers' AI Transformation Pain Points

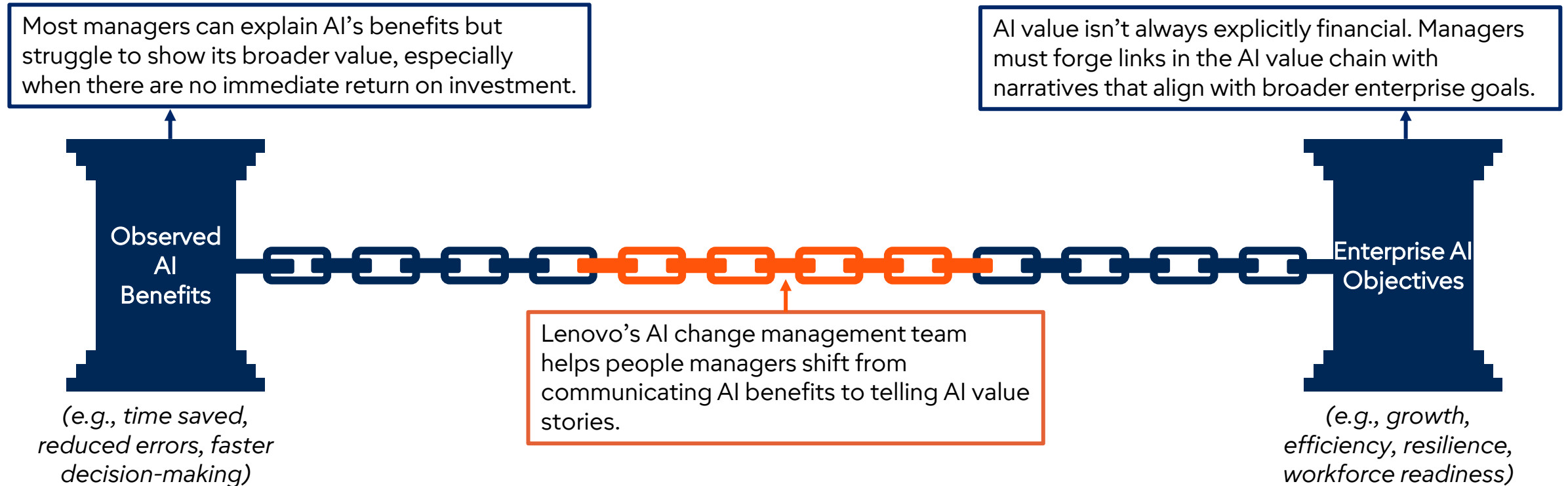
Empathy Map for People Managers (Illustrative, Partial)



Source: Adapted from Lenovo

Instill an Enterprise AI Value Mindset in Managers

Lenovo's Reframing of Managers as AI Value Storytellers (Illustrative)



“With AI, it’s not just about quick task wins but **amplified ROI** and the bigger impact those gains unlock. Managers need to see that broader picture and clearly communicate AI’s value to keep teams aligned with strategy.”

Sarah Lundgren, Director, Transformation Office, Lenovo

Coach Managers on Articulating AI Value Stories

Cheat Sheet to Help Managers Tailor AI Value Stories to Enterprise Priorities (Illustrative, Partial)

AI Value Stories			
1	2		3
If you observe	Don't just explain the AI benefit	Make your value story about	Support your story with metrics
Time savings	Developers on my team save six hours a week	Team of 10 now delivers work equivalent of an 11.5 person team	• Percentage increase in team output • Cost avoidance
	My team now has more time to learn and innovate.	New skills have enabled us to explore new business opportunities.	• Percentage decrease in skill gaps • New idea generation • Internal mobility rate

Examples and guidance help to show how AI meaningfully impacts enterprise outcomes.

A library of KPIs helps to strength value stories even when benefits are not directly linked to financial gains.

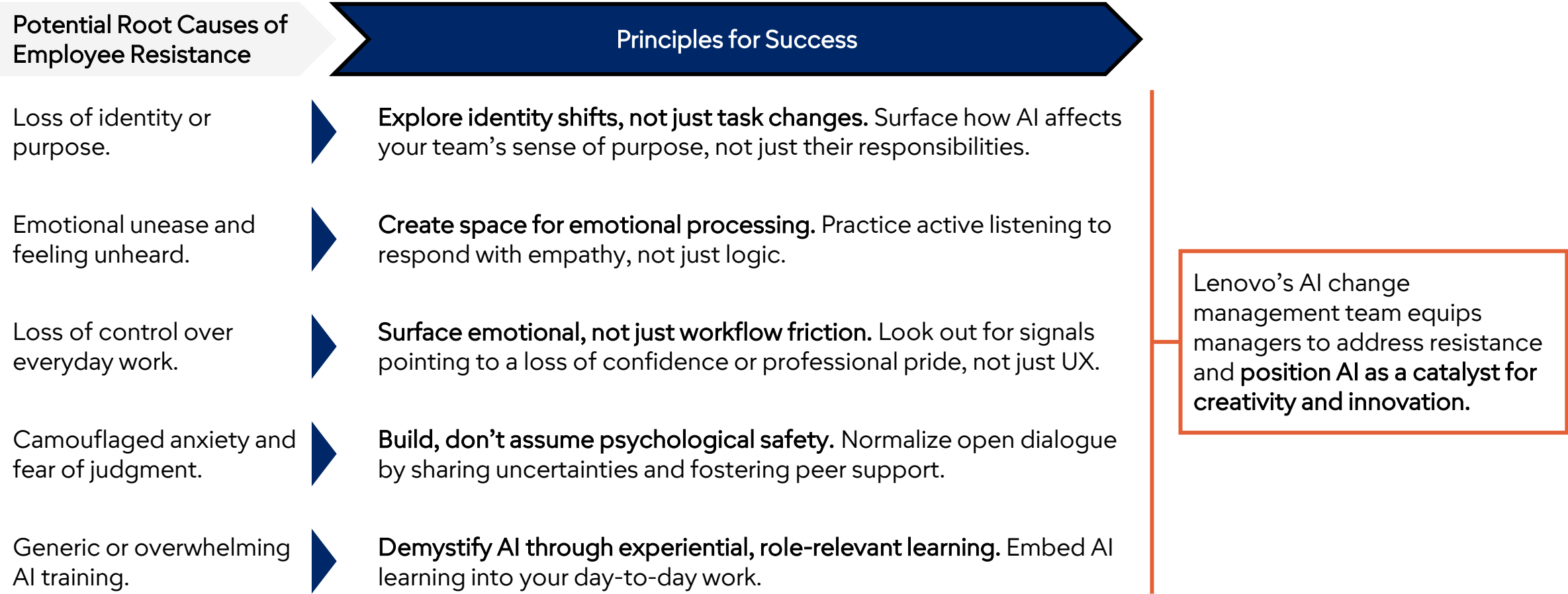
3 Steps for Managers to Create AI Value Stories

- 1 Spot the shift.** Zero in on a specific, real-world improvement AI has delivered.
- 2 Connect to what matters.** Map the benefit to a tangible business priority, clarifying how it supports enterprise goals.
- 3 Anchor in evidence.** Back the story with KPIs across the value chain to build credibility.



Prepare Managers for Employee AI Resistance

Lenovo's Principles to Help Managers Navigate Operational and Emotional Change Barriers



Source: Adapted from Lenovo



Equip Managers to Navigate Employee Resistance

Resources for Managers to Mitigate Emotional and Operational Change Barriers (Partial)

Diagnose Resistance

- ☐ **Active listening exercises**
Practice listening and responding with empathy.
- ☐ **Emotional intelligence coaching**
Build self-awareness, empathy, and resilience to manage change.
- ☐ **Empathy map co-creation**
Map your team's fears, hopes, frustrations, and needs together.

Prepare for Difficult Conversations

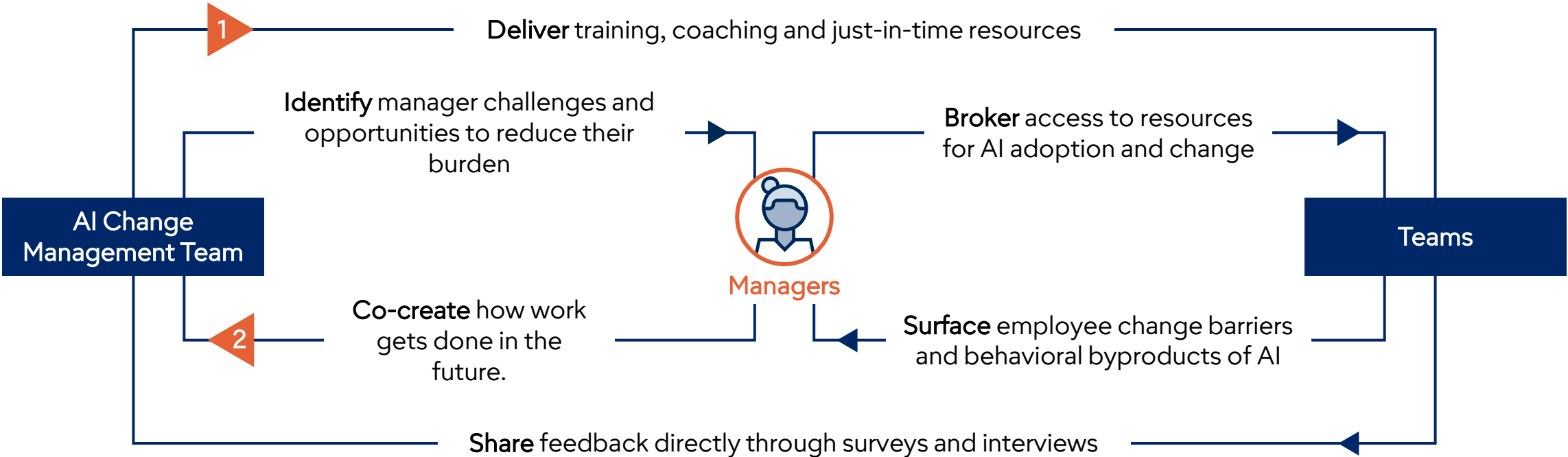
- ☐ **Conversation guides**
Use prompts to navigate sensitive conversations about AI change
- ☐ **Role play exercises**
Rehearse difficult scenarios using AI chatbots.

Share and Learn From Experiences

- ☐ **Peer cohorts**
Connect with other managers to share insights.
- ☐ **Manager champions**
Get practical tips from experienced peers on managing emotional resistance.
- ☐ **Microlearning modules**
Quick, on-demand learning before key moments.

Partner With Managers to Facilitate AI Change

Targeted Feedback Loops to Facilitate AI Change Co-Creation With Managers



1

The AI change management team prioritizes types of support for teams based on inputs from managers.

2

Managers co-create upskilling strategies, role evolution and new ways of working to shape the future of work for their teams.

Results

Select Outcomes of Lenovo’s AI Change Management Support for People Managers

Two-Group Experimental Design for Microsoft Copilot Adoption

Metric	Cohort A <i>License-only rollout</i>	Cohort B <i>Tailored AI adoption & change management support</i>
Average satisfaction	3.67 / 5	4.27 / 5
Daily usage	67%	91%
Issue rate	33%	18%
Average hours saved per week	1.8	3.5

“With support from the AI change management team, I’m not just seeing better adoption but measurable gains. We’re being more productive, improving quality, and lowering service costs.”

People Manager, Lenovo Contact Centre

“I used to talk about AI in terms of time saved or fewer clicks — things that didn’t resonate with leadership. The pressure to prove value from AI was intense, but I didn’t know how. The change support helped me reframe the story. Now, I talk about how AI helps us move faster, make better decisions, and hit business goals. That shift changed everything.”

People Manager, Lenovo SSG

88% Business area satisfaction and preparedness for AI ^a

6x increase in adoption of AI Enterprise Search Assist Tool

^a Based on responses from managers and users, this score reflects the positive impact and preparedness of people managers in leading AI-related change.

Source: Adapted from Lenovo

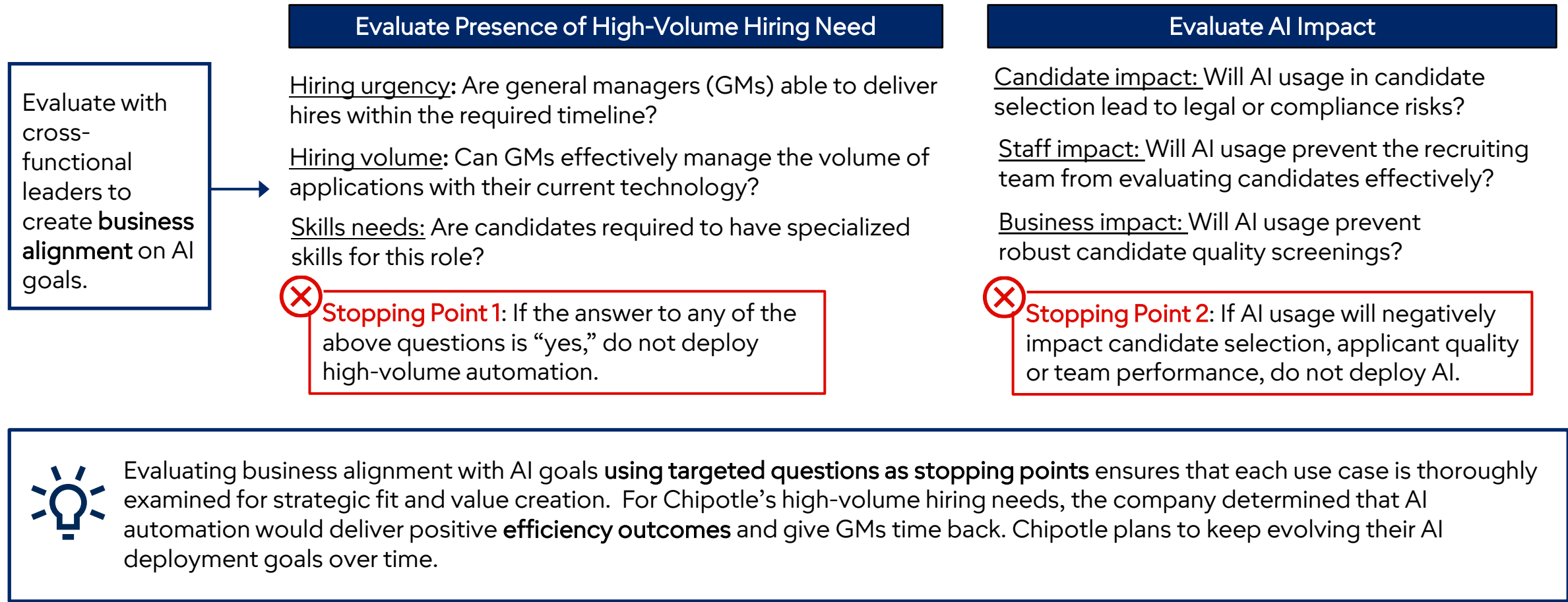


Chipotle (AI Assistant in High-Volume Hiring)

AI Deployment Criteria Drives Strategic AI Usage

Chipotle's AI Deployment Criteria

Illustrative



Source: Adapted from Chipotle

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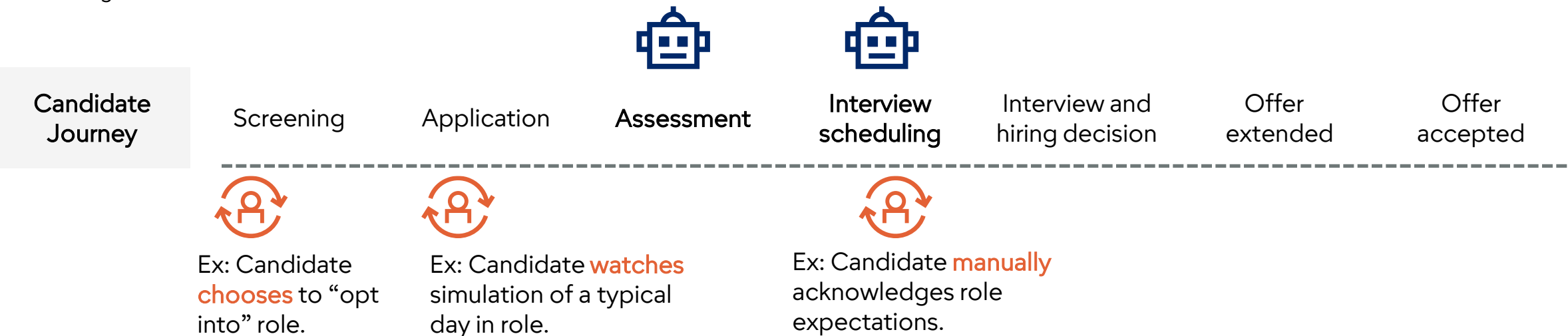


Candidate Safeguards Ensure Quality of Hire

Chipotle’s In-Progress Vision for Candidate Quality Safeguards Illustrative

 AI-Enabled Process

 Candidate Quality Safeguard



Chipotle plans to add **manual processes** to the AI-enabled recruiting journey to ensure that candidates understand the **expectations** of their roles. The company will pilot this approach for recruiting technology use later this year.

